

T E C H N O V A 2 0 2 6



ZERO SIGNAL

The galaxy is encrypted and you're the only key. Do you have what it takes?

C A P T U R E T H E F L A G

SPONSORED BY



DESIGNED BY

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// OPERATION · OFFICIAL RULE BOOK

ZERO SIGNAL

CAPTURE THE FLAG

DECRYPT. INFILTRATE. DOMINATE.

2-3

CREW SIZE

AUG 1ST

2026

10:00-1:00

AM

PM

IoBM

KARACHI

// THE_MISSION

01

THE MISSION

THE GALAXY HAS GONE DARK

The year is 2147. A rogue AI known only as VOID has hijacked humanity's deep space communication network and encrypted all satellite signals.

Enter the network, where a galaxy of encrypted servers, signal traps, and rival operatives awaits.

In Operation: Zero Signal, each team is an elite crew of Cyber Navigators.

You must infiltrate VOID's system layer by layer, crack its encryptions, and recover the stolen signal keys — called Zero Signals — hidden across six deadly planets.

But the galaxy is alive! NPC firewall bots guard the most valuable signals. Rival crews race through the same planets. In the final round, only one crew can hold THE SUMMIT — every second they hold it, they pull further ahead.

// MISSION_BRIEF

02 MISSION BRIEF

KNOW BEFORE YOU LAUNCH

- ▶ **+Crew size:** 2-3 Navigators
- ▶ **Format:** space-themed Capture the Flag arena
- ▶ **Style:** progressive puzzle + live territory war
- ▶ **Duration:** ~3 hours
- ▶ **Window:** 10:00 AM - 1:00 PM
- ▶ **Flag format:** **ZEROSIG{...}** strictly enforced
- ▶ **AI tools:** all LLMs & AI assistants permitted and encouraged

// HOW_IT_WORKS

03 HOW IT WORKS

INFILTRATE · SOLVE · CAPTURE

- ▶ Explore the galaxy and **capture flags** by solving challenges across its planets.
- ▶ The arena runs in **multiple rounds** that escalate in difficulty.
- ▶ It's an **elimination format**, crews are cut as the galaxy narrows; only the strongest signal advances.
- ▶ A **live territory element** rewards strategy beyond raw solving, control the map, and expect rivals to contest you.
- ▶ Everything runs inside a **simulated galaxy** on the official competition platform.

// The full run-of-show is revealed live at the event.

// SKILL_AREAS

04 SKILL AREAS

SHARPEN UP ACROSS ALL FIVE

- ▶ CRYPTOGRAPHY
- +
- ▶ STEGANOGRAPHY
- ▶ OSINT open-source intelligence
- ▶ WEB EXPLOITATION
- ▶ REVERSE ENGINEERING

// Challenges escalate and combine as you go deeper — fluency across all five is your edge.

+

// SCORING

05 SCORING

OUTSCAN · OUTCRACK · OUTTHINK

- ▶ **Harder challenges are worth more**, difficulty scales with reward.
- ▶ **Bonuses** favor speed (being first), holding territory, and fully clearing an area.
- ▶ **Ties** are broken by the faster total solve time.
- +
- ▶ **Strategy wins**, balance solving, speed, and map control, not just raw flag count.

// RULES_OF_PLAY

06 RULES OF PLAY

THE SIGNAL CODE

- ▶ Access all challenges **only** through the official competition platform.
- ▶ **AI tools** (LLMs & assistants) are permitted and encouraged.
- ▶ **No collaboration between crews;** your signal, your glory.
- ▶ Interact **only with your own challenges;** interfering with another crew's session is prohibited.
- ▶ **No real-world exploits** against competition infrastructure. All hacking stays inside the simulated galaxy.
- ▶ Flags must match **ZEROSIG{...}** exactly; other formats are rejected.

// DISQUALIFICATION

07 DISQUALIFICATION

CROSS THESE AND YOUR SIGNAL GOES DARK

EJECTION FROM THE GALAXY

- ▶ Misconduct or violating event decorum
- ▶ Tampering with the platform, the galaxy system, or another crew's session outside in-game mechanics
- ▶ External human assistance from anyone outside your registered crew
- ▶ Disruptive behavior, at the organizers' discretion
- ▶ **Sharing flags or solutions** with rival crews; instant DQ for **both** crews
- ▶ **Deploying real exploits** against competition infrastructure; instant DQ

// Organizers may adapt rules for unforeseen circumstances. Their decision is final.

THE GALAXY IS ENCRYPTED,
AND YOU'RE THE ONLY KEY.
ENTER THE ARENA.

DECRYPT. INFILTRATE. DOMINATE.

TECHNOVA2026 | CTF ARENA | ZERO SIGNAL

MODULE DESIGN TEAM

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